

Having received reports on the plight of the Jews, I am sure you will be interested with documentation of the same. (See memo 12/19/42)

that information was available to the representatives in Switzerland but **MEMORANDUM FOR THE PERSONAL INFORMATION OF CORDELL HULL** by such

reports through open cables or radio. In these cables, the fact that the German and Lithuanian were being rescued by the Swiss and the British Foreign Office as expressed in the cable of December 15 from our Embassy in London. I also fully understand the point which you made to the effect that, since you are not able to personally follow the administrative handling of such matters, they frequently bog down until they are called to your personal attention.

At our conference on Monday, December 20, I was deeply impressed by your sympathetic attitude toward the whole problem of working out programs to rescue Jews in enemy territory. As I had expected, you as well as I were astounded by the position of the British Foreign Office as expressed in the cable of December 15 from our Embassy in London. I also fully understand the point which you made to the effect that, since you are not able to personally follow the administrative handling of such matters, they frequently bog down until they are called to your personal attention.

Since my letters to you of November 24 and December 17, in which I pointed out certain delays which had been involved in the particular case in question since April of this year, certain facts relating to events prior to April have been called to my attention which I feel impelled to bring to your personal attention. Unless there is some explanation for these facts which does not appear on the basis of the information which has been furnished to this Department, the story which they tell will I am sure be as shocking to you as it was to me.

A. The following facts relate to action taken by certain officials of your Department in connection with the matter of obtaining information concerning the plans of the German Government for the complete extermination of the Jews in Europe.

(2) On October 5, 1942 Sumner Welles as Acting Secretary of State sent a cable (2314) for the personal attention of Minister Harrison in Bern stating that leaders of the Jewish Congress had received reports from their representatives in Geneva and London to the effect that many thousands of Jews in Eastern Europe were being slaughtered pursuant to a policy embarked upon by the German Government for the complete extermination of the Jews in Europe. Welles added that he was trying to obtain further information from the Vatican but that other than this he was unable to secure confirmation of these stories. He stated that Rabbi Wise believed

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